

Does more RO mean recovery?

Reverse-osmosis supply, groundwater status and the Għar Lapsi tender

THE CLAIM

“70.7% ... from the four Reverse Osmosis plants”

Water Services Corporation, Annual Report 2025

WSC production, 2022–2025 · Plant B tender, August 2026

A lower WSC groundwater share is not proof of aquifer recovery.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

*WSC reliance fell;
aquifers last assessed as poor.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

70.7%

WSC production from RO

In 2025, up from 64.3% in 2022. WSC groundwater production fell to 11.5 million m³.

4%

of national groundwater use

WSC's 2025 cut (1.55 million m³) against an estimated 38.5 million m³ abstracted in 2024; 57% goes to farming.

0 of 15

bodies in good overall status

Both main aquifers are over-abstracted; Malta's EU reporting lists all 15 as poor chemically.

15–40 yrs

travel time, Malta's main aquifer

Peer-reviewed tracer study: changes in water quality take years to decades to show.

30,000 m³/day

planned Għar Lapsi Plant B

Tendered in August 2026; not commissioned or measured output.

FAIR TO SAY

RO supplied more of WSC's potable water and its groundwater production fell, to WSC's lowest in a decade. That is real, but small beside national use, and not proof of recovery.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Publish metered abstraction and recharge by groundwater body and user.

☐ Monitor water levels, salinity and nitrate on a comparable basis.

☐ Reconcile WSC's 11.4% narrative with its 11.86% chart-derived decline.

☐ Report Plant B's actual output and its effect on groundwater production.